



STATUS REPORT

Rwanda: status report

Edition of 2026-08-13 · 87 systems and instruments tracked, 9 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-10 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/RWA/ledger.csv](#) (87 systems and instruments, 9 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

Rwanda runs one national instant payment rail carrying every domestic interoperable retail payment at a maximum of RWF 20 between institutions, a biometric identity programme [4.4 million enrolments into a roughly 14 million target](#), and a data-protection law in force since 2021 that has never produced a published enforcement action or register of controllers. Third-generation networks are dated for [nationwide switch-off on 30 June 2027](#). Not one new Rwandan statute reached the books in the twelve months the base can evidence, and the domestically financed share of the ministry's development programme fell for a third consecutive year while its externally financed share rose to [RWF 65.8bn](#).

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Country partnership framework	PLANNED ↗	Prepared, not formally launched
Cross-border terrestrial fibre route	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Switched on 2026-02-09
Digital acceleration project	IMPLEMENTED ↗	55% complete as at 2025-07-07
Fifth-generation network	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched June 2025
Government network	PLANNED ↗	Named as a subcomponent carrying US\$33.5m
National broadband policy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Revised in 2022, abandoning the single-wholesale-network model
New subsea cable system	PLANNED ↗	Announced early July 2026, no timeline given

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Satellite reseller authorisation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Certified by the space agency, partnership since December 2025
Second-generation network switch-off	PLANNED ↗	December 2028 stated as a government working target
Shared tower investment	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A development institution committed US\$44.4m September 2025
Third-generation network switch-off	PLANNED ↗	Dated 30 June 2027 by the ministry
Voice over fourth-generation networks	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched, reported 2026-08-03

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Data centre and cloud service directives	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Issued 2023, dated only by the ministry's sector plan
Data centre memorandum with a Gulf operator	PLANNED ↗	Memorandum signed 2026-05-29
Digital investment roadmap	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched at an investment conference October 2025
Hybrid cloud deployment	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-04-17
National data centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Named in the ministry's sector plan for 2024 to 2029

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Data-centre water policy	NOT HELD	No instrument identified; an analyst calls for early planning

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Institute of computing	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Cabinet approved 2026-07-24, opening September 2026
Sovereign AI compute	NOT HELD	No national accelerator cluster or sovereign AI cloud named

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Biometric SIM registration regulation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Issued August 2024, pilot September 2024
Cyber security centre of excellence	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Inaugurated 2025-10-02
National computer security incident response team	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Profile published 2022-06-30 under the 2017 authority law
National cyber security authority	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Appropriated under the presidency for a third consecutive year

The ministry [fixed 30 June 2027 for the third-generation shutdown](#) on 28 July 2026, with operator pilot shutdowns during 2026, and named December 2028 as a working target for the older network — expressly conditional on coverage, voice reliability, mobile money continuity, dependent-system migration and affordable handsets. A government-commissioned study found more than two million people could still be on that network in 2030 without a planned transition; the study is unpublished, so its method is unestablished. Voice over fourth-generation networks, the technical precondition, switched on days later, with no coverage or handset-base figure published.

Fifth-generation service launched in June 2025 with no site or subscriber figure since, and the most recent internet-penetration figure is a projection for end-2025 rather than a measurement. Regulator statistics for the first quarter of 2026 give 14,001,080 mobile-cellular subscriptions at 97.1 per 100 inhabitants and 10,738,906 internet subscriptions. The largest connectivity instrument, a US\$200m acceleration project, was last reported 55% complete in July 2025 and has published no figure since against a December 2026 closing date.

A hyperscaler hybrid-cloud deployment went live in April 2026, with deployment count and host facilities undisclosed — the only onshore compute named. The ministry's sector plan records a [50% hosting-price cut at the national data centre and 14.9% of 4,660 government websites and web applications hosted in the country](#), and dates the data centre and cloud service directives to 2023. The national incident response team's [profile of 30 June 2022](#) gives its constituency and its statutory basis in the 2017 authority law, and publishes no caseload, resolution time or service-level target.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National data-sharing platform	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Phased for 2025 to 2026, with no go-live announced
National data-sharing policy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Approved 2025, open by default with a safe-access framework
National digital public infrastructure strategy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched at a first national infrastructure day 2026-03-09

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Consent and access-log layer	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Described as the consent and access-log layer, with no go-live stated
Single digital identity	IN DEVELOPMENT, NATIONWIDE ENROLMENT UNDER WAY ↗	Nationwide registration launched 2025-08-07

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Bank and mobile-money credit product	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-08-02
Cross-border payment corridor pilot	PILOTING ↗	A proof of concept advanced at a technical meeting, no launch date
Licence passporting framework with a neighbour	PLANNED ↗	Central-bank memorandum signed March 2026
National instant payment system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	All domestic interoperable retail payments migrated 2026-07-14 by directive

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Business registration platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Registration moved entirely online January 2026
District land correction exercise	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Concluded 2026-06-17

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Land administration twinning	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Activity period 2022 to 2027, continuing earlier support

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
e-Tracker electronic immunization registry	IMPLEMENTED ↗	MoH directive of October 2022 mandated the end of paper immunization records; DHIS2-based registry phased in September 2019 to January 2020 across 500+ facilities, integrated with CRVS/ NIDA in early 2022
National electronic medical record	PLANNED ↗	A blueprint from one hospital build, with no rollout date
National health intelligence centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched April 2025

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Electronic billing machine as an export	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Two neighbours adopted, a third mid-adoption
Electronic procurement platform as an export	IMPLEMENTED ↗	One state adopting and co-developing

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Local-government citizen platform	PILOTING ↗	A capital-city trial opened 2026-01-27

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Space programme appropriation	NOT HELD	The last held record is the 2024/25 appropriation

Effective 14 July 2026 the central bank [migrated all domestic interoperable retail payments onto one state-owned open-source rail](#) by directive, connecting 22 institutions; a bank-to-wallet transfer that could previously cost as much as RWF 5,000 now costs [at most RWF 20](#), about one US cent – a maximum that applies between institutions, with each operator's own tariff on transfers inside its network unchanged. Reconcile settled the point on 2026-08-09: the banking industry's own public notice of 14 July 2026 puts it as a maximum fee of RWF 20 with institutions free to charge less or nothing, on every transfer between banks and electronic money issuers, so it is a ceiling on interoperability rather than a flat retail price. **The instrument behind it is not held.** BNR Directive No. 45/2026 is absent from the central bank's document library as enumerated on 2026-08-09 (493 documents), its issue date is given variously as 9 January and 9 June 2026, and nothing on file states what governs on-net tariffs if the ceiling does not. A bank and a mobile-money operator launched [instant loans of up to RWF 2,000,000 and wallet saving over a short code](#) on 2 August 2026, with no pricing, interest rate or eligibility rule published. The physical layer moved the other way: the second operator's market share fell from 16.9% to 14.3% and its active agents from 53,316 to 48,847 over the same year, in the cash-in and cash-out network the new rail does not touch.

Identity is enrolling against a hard deadline. Nationwide registration opened on 7 August 2025 and reached 4.4 million by June 2026; no figure has been published since, in the run-up to a June 2027 sunset after which legacy cards become invalid and banks, hospitals, telecoms operators and government institutions are expected to use the new authentication. The consent and access-log layer on which the privacy design rests has no go-live date, no live status and no user figure.

The exchange layer is the gap the country's own analysts name most often. A national data-sharing policy was approved in May 2025 and its governance unit is now staffed, but the platform itself has no go-live announcement with its 2026 target year eight months gone. The stack is being sold abroad: [two neighbours have adopted the electronic billing machine](#), a third is mid-adoption, and one state has taken the electronic procurement platform and is co-developing it – with no revenue, contract value or licensing terms disclosed for any adoption.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Central bank regulatory sandbox	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Established 2022
Draft law on virtual assets	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	The lower house approved the rationale 2026-04-01
Single digital identification law	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A June 2027 sunset of all legacy documents written into the law

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
ICT sector strategic plan	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Replaced the 2018 to 2024 plan, covering 2024/25 to 2028/29
Legacy-network retirement plan	PLANNED ↗	The government approved a phased retirement plan
National artificial intelligence agency	PLANNED ↗	Cabinet approval 2026-06-08
National artificial intelligence policy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Cabinet approval April 2023
National data-sharing policy implementation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Cabinet approval 2025-05-26
National AI risk-assessment and harms-monitoring body	NOT HELD	Engagements run November 2025 to March 2026
Review framework for commercial AI partnerships	NOT HELD	A three-year vendor memorandum signed February 2026 without one

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Bilateral licence passporting memorandum	IMPLEMENTED, TEXT UNPUBLISHED ↗	Signed February 2025
COMESA regional AI framework	PLANNED ↗	Kigali country consultations held 2026-08-03 under COMESA's IDEA Programme

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Cross-border data-exchange conformance	PILOTING ↗	The capital hosted a technical assessment mission April 2026
Electronic-government interoperability framework	IMPLEMENTED, FUNCTIONAL EQUIVALENT HELD ↗	Rwanda Government-wide Enterprise Architecture Framework (RGEA) v2.1 document acquired (excerpt)

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Data protection and privacy law	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A two-year grace period ended 2023-10-15
Data-protection supervisory authority	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Named supervisory authority under the 2021 law
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	IMPLEMENTED, SIGNED (NON-BINDING PER SECTION 6.9) ↗	Signed at Washington 2025-12-05 by Foreign Minister Olivier Nduhungirehe; text republished by Public Citizen

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Internet governance forum	IMPLEMENTED ↗	The 2026 edition convened 2026-07-30

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
European adequacy decision	NOT HELD	None sought or granted

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
National open-data portal or policy	NOT HELD	No portal, catalogue or policy on file

The data-protection law has been in its enforcement phase since October 2023, carries extraterritorial reach and fines to RWF 5m or 1% of global turnover, and requires the supervisory authority to authorise every transfer of personal data out of the country. In five years it has produced [no published enforcement action, fine total, breach register or count of registered controllers](#). Its appropriation is [RWF 130m for 2026/27](#), flat and down from RWF 150m before that, of which the 2024/25 vote was spent at 35.1%, all in one quarter; the national identification programme executed at 140.7% of its appropriation.

The sector's plan for 2024/25 to 2028/29 replaced the 2018 to 2024 plan, with no progress report against its nine outcomes held. A national artificial-intelligence agency was [approved by Cabinet on 8 June 2026](#) with its structure, operations and timeline not made public and no establishing law held. A virtual-assets bill had its rationale approved on 1 April 2026, with nothing on record since. Rwanda's bilateral health agreements with the United States, and the data-sharing agreements attached to them, are [withheld and in litigation](#) since 2 April 2026.

A development agency reported in July 2026, from engagements run to March 2026, that Rwandan participants said [no dedicated national organisation conducts risk assessments, evaluations or active monitoring of artificial-intelligence errors and harms](#). No review framework is triggered by a commercial partnership either.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Bilateral AI memorandum with a North African state	IMPLEMENTED, SIGNED ↗	Signed at a UN summit 2026-07-10
Continental AI declaration	IMPLEMENTED, NON-BINDING ↗	Adopted in the capital April 2025
Continental AI fund	PLANNED ↗	Announced at the capital's summit, April 2025
Global AI summit	IMPLEMENTED, ONE EDITION HELD ↗	First edition held April 2025
Head of state's international AI commission role	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Confirmed as co-chair 2026-07-03
Primary-care AI health pilot	PILOTING ↗	Announced 2026-01-22, this country first
Regional AI policy roadmap	PLANNED ↗	Explored at a regional science conference, March 2026
Vendor memorandum with a frontier AI firm	IMPLEMENTED, NON-BINDING ↗	Signed 2026-02-17
Sovereign AI compute or national model	NOT HELD	No cluster, facility or hosted model named

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Development bank venture debt fund	IN DEVELOPMENT, NOT CLOSED ↗	No commitment or approval date given
Financial technology centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Inaugurated 2026-03-12
Innovation city	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Groundbreaking September 2024
Innovation fund	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Twelve companies backed by 2024

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Bilateral technology instrument with China	NOT HELD	An exploratory ambassadorial meeting, January 2026

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Indian-origin technology investment	PLANNED, CORPORATE PROJECTION ONLY ↗	Named as a future edge site, December 2024

The commercial stack arrived before the institutions meant to govern it. A three-year non-binding memorandum with a frontier artificial-intelligence firm was [signed on 17 February 2026](#) covering the health ministry, public-sector developer teams and education; the vendor's own announcement is the only primary held and no value is published.

A US\$50m primary-care health pilot announced the previous month begins in Rwanda and scales to 1,000 clinics by 2028, with no clinic count published since. The national agency was approved in June, and an institute of computing was approved on 24 July to open in September 2026 — its first two intakes limited to graduates of a single secondary academy.

The measurable side is employment and it is genuinely moving off a small base. The information and communication sector [employed 19,000 workers in the second quarter of 2026 against about 12,000 a year earlier](#) — up 62.6% against 2.7% economy-wide, still about 0.4% of total employment, against a target of 50,000 digital jobs by 2029. The fisc moved the other way: the science, technology and innovation appropriation fell 7.3% to RWF 856.6m for 2026/27, all recurrent with no domestically financed development.

The continental instruments Rwanda hosts have not converted into delivery. A declaration adopted in the capital in April 2025 endorsed a council and a US\$60bn fund; sixteen months on, neither has a constitution, capitalisation, manager or first disbursement.

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Smart-device affordability fund	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Design stage, market assessment pending
Universal access or service fund	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Presidential order gazetted 2023-05-15, repealing the 2004 order

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Digital ambassador programme	IMPLEMENTED, FINANCING PHASE CONCLUDED ↗	The financing phase concluded May 2026
National AI literacy teacher programme	IMPLEMENTED, FIRST PHASE ↗	A first phase reported complete at end-2025

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Coding academy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A record of discussion signed September 2021
Inclusive digital transformation centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A foundation partnership signed 2022

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Continental research and education partnership	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A grant of about US\$9m from 2022 to 2027

Formal financial access reached [96% of adults in 2024 against 48% in 2008](#), with 68.5% using a mobile wallet and about 5% holding a bank account. The agent network lags its market: the second operator's agent count fell over the year interoperability was meant to help. The urban and rural internet-use gap, 57% against 19%, is unchanged: the survey has not been repeated.

[4,184 of 4,996 schools were connected as at March 2026](#), leaving 812 mostly rural — rural connectivity at about 27% against roughly 75% urban, against an 80% target. Nothing has been published since.

A digital-ambassador programme concluded its financing phase in May 2026 having trained 1,567,034 citizens, with no successor financing held.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	AS AT
Digital acceleration project, inclusion components	IMPLEMENTED ↗	An authority briefing to Parliament 2025-07-07
Regional bank digital acceleration operation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Board approval 2021, period 2022 to 2026

Two external financing instruments both close in 2026 without a clear disbursement record: the digital acceleration project was last reported 55% complete in July 2025, and a regional development bank operation carries no disbursement figure at any date.

Domestic capacity financing moved in opposite directions across a single budget: an education technology integration line rose 23.1% to RWF 28.96bn while a second line fell 34.4%, and the cyber-security standards and skills line sat flat for a second year after spending 11.5% of its 2024/25 vote.

A universal access fund set up by a [presidential order of 12 May 2023](#) caps each licensee's annual contribution at 2.5% of the turnover of each regulated service category; the rate actually set is a regulatory-board decision the base does not hold. Its latest accounts on file, for 2020/21, report [Frw 3,828,837,334 spent against a Frw 6,372,536,516 budget](#).

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Data-centre water policy	the only country-specific energy source the base holds; probed 2026-08-05, no instrument on data-centre water use exists; the cloud directives cover cooling and humidity but not water	2026-08-05
Sovereign AI compute	named-analyst opinion whose author sells sovereign AI infrastructure; probed 2026-08-05, no government document establishes national AI compute capacity; the nearest instrument is a continental pre-qualification exercise, not a Rwandan programme	2026-08-05
Space programme appropriation	the only satellite-data source the base holds for this country; probed 2026-08-05, the 2023/24 development budget annex carries the space agency by project and funding type	2026-08-05

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National AI risk-assessment and harms-monitoring body	qualitative workshops, not a survey, and the report claims no representativeness; probed 2026-08-05, no such body is constituted; the 2023 AI policy only recommends a responsible AI office, which an external observatory recorded as not yet operational in February 2026, and the June 2026 AI agency's establishing law was not found	2026-08-05
Review framework for commercial AI partnerships	external commentary, attributed not adopted; probed 2026-08-05, no instrument requiring review or disclosure of commercial AI partnerships exists; the only material found is external commentary asserting the same	2026-08-05
National open-data portal or policy	probed 2026-08-05, the live data sharing platform and the 2017 data revolution policy located; the national data sharing policy expressly scopes open data out; acquisition attempted 2026-08-05 and failed, absence now stated dated on the place hub	2026-08-05
European adequacy decision	desk-review analysis, with the counts round estimates single-sourced to a secondary tracker; probed 2026-08-05, the Commission's own list of recognised third countries names no African state, establishing the negative as at 2026	2026-08-05
Sovereign AI compute or national model	a named analyst's dependency argument plus the absence of any contrary record; probed 2026-08-05, a June 2026 cabinet decision creating an AI agency is reported but no establishing law, gazette entry or compute procurement was found, and the only national-model candidate is a private company announcement	2026-08-05
Bilateral technology instrument with China	surveillance supply is asserted only at continent level with no national contract named; probed 2026-08-05, a signatory embassy's own account gives the December 2021 smart education loan framework agreement, whose text is unpublished; a 2017 vendor memorandum is likewise only described	2026-08-05

The consent and access-log layer is the safeguard the privacy-by-design case for the identity programme rests on, and it is the one component with no delivery evidence — a gap that matters more each month enrolment scales toward the June 2027 sunset. And the government data-sharing platform, on which the interoperability of everything else depends, has no go-live announcement with its target year two-thirds gone.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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